

National Coverage Determination (NCD)

Acupuncture

30.3

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

30.3

Manual Section Title

Acupuncture

Version Number

2

Effective Date of this Version

01/21/2020

Implementation Date

06/24/2020

Description Information

Benefit Category

Incident to a physician's professional Service

Inpatient Hospital Services

Outpatient Hospital Services Incident to a Physician's Service

Physicians' Services

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Item/Service Description

A. General

Acupuncture is the selection and manipulation of specific acupuncture points by a variety of needling and non-needling techniques.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

B. Nationally Covered Indications

Effective for claims with dates of service on and after January 21, 2020, acupuncture is only covered for chronic low back pain under section 1862(a)(1)(A) of the Social Security Act (the Act). See National Coverage Determination section 30.3.3 for specific coverage criteria.

C. Nationally Non-Covered Indications

Medicare reimbursement for acupuncture, as an anesthetic, or as an analgesic or for other therapeutic purposes, may not be made unless the specific indication is excepted. All indications for acupuncture outside of NCD section 30.3.3 remain non-covered.

D. Other

N/A

(This NCD last reviewed January 2020.)

Claims Processing Instructions

[TN 10128 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#) 

Transmittal Information

Transmittal Number

10128

Coverage Transmittal Link

<https://www.cms.gov/files/document/R10128NCD.pdf> 

Revision History

05/2020 - The purpose of this change request is to inform MACs that CMS will cover acupuncture for chronic low back pain (cLBP) effective for claims with dates of service on and after January 21, 2020. ([TN 10128](#) ) (CR11755)

National Coverage Analyses (NCAs)

This NCD has been or is currently being reviewed under the National Coverage Determination process. The following are existing associations with NCAs, from the National Coverage Analyses database.

- [Original Consideration for Acupuncture for Nausea after Chemotherapy and Post-operative Pain \(CAG-00062N\)](#)
- [Original Consideration for Acupuncture for Fibromyalgia \(CAG-00174N\)](#)
- [Original Consideration for Acupuncture for Osteoarthritis \(CAG-00175N\)](#)

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Acupuncture	2	01/21/2020 - N/A	You are here
Acupuncture	1	01/01/1966 - 01/21/2020	View